Collection

Toch HaNachal

(Within the Stream)

Wonderful words which were spoken

on *Shabbat Parshas Tzav* 5769

By the *Rav* and *Tzaddik*,

Mohorosh *Shlit"a*

Collected and Printed

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Friday Night, Parshas Tzav 5769

On Friday Night, Mohorosh *Shlit"a*, spoke inspiring words regarding the enthusiasm of the heart and the concept of *tzimtzum* (constriction) based on the words of Rebbe Nachman in *Likutei Mohoran*, Part I, Lesson 49.

Rebbe Nachman says, "Before Creation, Hashem's Light was infinite. But Hashem wanted that His *Malkhut* (Kingship) should be revealed, for there is no king without a people, so He had to create human beings who would accept the responsibility of His Kingship. However, the revelation of His Kingship is possible only by way of the Attributes. By way of the Attributes we can grasp His G-dliness and know that there is a Master, Ruler and Guide. So He constricted the Infinite Light to the sides, leaving a Vacated Space. Within this Vacated Space He created the worlds (see beginning of *Etz Chaim*, 1:3). These very worlds are His Attributes. Now, the heart is the *tzayeir* (designer) of the Attributes. This refers to the wisdom of the heart, as written (*Shemos* 31:6), "In the heart of every wise heart…," for the worlds were formed essentially with wisdom, as written (*Tehillim* 104:24), "You made them all with wisdom". Hence, the heart is the *TzayeiR*, as it is written (*Tehillim* 73:26), "*TzuR* (rock) of my heart". And now, there is formation of good and of bad, as our sages said (*Berachos* 61a), "*va'YeitZeR*" (He formed) is written with two *yuds*, representing the two inclinations – the good and evil inclinations". In other words, good thoughts are the good inclination, and evil thoughts are the evil inclination. The essence of these inclinations is the thoughts and wisdom that are in the heart, as it written (*Bereishis* 6:5), "The inclination of the thoughts of his heart". So when a person thinks evil thoughts, he is contaminating the Vacated Space of Creation in which the Attributes are revealed, for the heart is the designer of the worlds – the Attributes. This is because the radiance of the enthusiasm of the Jewish heart would not allow for the Attributes to be revealed. The radiance of this enthusiasm is infinite, meaning that there is no limit or boundary to these yearnings. Thus, one must constrict the enthusiasm so that a vacated space will remain in the heart, as it is written (*Tehillim* 109:22), "My heart is hollowed within me". And by way of the constriction of the enthusiasm – that is, by serving God gradually and in proper measure – the Attributes can be revealed." (These are the words of Rebbe Nachman).

Mohorosh explained that Rebbe Nachman is revealing to us in this lesson a wonderful secret regarding the Creation and development of the worlds. That all of the Act of Creation and the entire worlds were created within a person's mind in a literal sense. And according to how a person prepares himself in order to receive within him Hashem's Infinite light, so does he renew the entire creation at all times; elevating and binding himself to Hashem each time anew. For it is explained in the writings of the Arizal (beginning of *Eitz Chaim* 1:3) that when Hashem wanted to create all of the worlds, the only thing that exist was Hashem's Infinite light and

there was no place to create the world, because everything was filled with G-dliness. So Hashem constricted His light in order to make a Vacated Space from His own G-dliness. It was within this space that the worlds were created and this place was called the "Vacated Space", because it seemed as though it was a place devoid of G-dliness. However, this was only to make room for the creation; because in truth, Hashem's Will is hidden there. We see that it was specifically through the constriction and concealment that Hashem made a place that seemed as though His G-dliness is not present there. Through this, a place for the creation was made; and it was from there that all of the worlds expanded.

Rebbe Nachman explains that all of this is literally repeated at all times within a person's mind – which is a "small world". Each time a constriction and concealment is made within a person's mind and heart; and it seems to him as though Hashem's light is not present there. And the person's main task is to find Hashem's light within that place, which is called the power of free choice. That the person has free choice to choose good and believe that Hashem's light is concealed within this vacated space, and bind himself to Hashem's Will in every detail; or to think that Hashem's G-dliness is not found there, may Hashem spare us, doing whatever his heart desires. It is preci ely due to a person's power of free choice that one is able to serve Him with the Attribute of "constriction"; elevating and binding himself to Hashem within every detail of the Creation. For were it not for constriction and concealment, it would not be possible to perform any act or service for Hashem; because the light of enthusiasm within one's heart would burn indefinitely, and he wouldn't be able to do anything at all. This would cause him to become burned out due to the high intensity of the light and the cleaving to Hashem. But now that there's a constriction and concealment, one is able to organize his ideas and attributes in order to find Hashem in them, in order to serve Him with the Attribute of constriction.

This is Hashem's main desire; for there are myriads upon myriads of angels that serve Him without any free choice at all. They fulfill His Will with a great enthusiasm; but, afterwards, they are consumed altogether due to the great intensity of the light. However, Hashem created man in this world in order for him to possess the power of free choice and merit to find Hashem within the concealment and constriction. And through this he would cause Hashem much pleasure and joy. Therefore, even though from one side we need to have the attribute of quickness – to be quick in serving Hashem – nevertheless, we still need to have the attribute of constriction. And through binding them as one we merit comprehending high levels of Hashem's G-dliness. We see from this that the main perfection of serving Hashem is precisely within the concealment and constriction; and the more things are concealed and covered up, the more one binds himself to Hashem when he finds His G-dliness there.

Therefore, a person doesn't really fall when he experiences a constricted consciousness, concealment and forgetfulness; even if it seems to him as though he has yet to begin doing anything good in his life. He should remind himself that now he's beginning anew altogether. It is precisely within the darkness and the concealment that a wondrous light comes out, as it is written in the beginning of the Creation (*Bereishis* 1:2-3), "Now the earth was devoid and void, and darkness was upon the face of the deep…and God said, 'Let there be light, and there was light'". He should know that the entire purpose of the darkness is only a test to maintain free choice; in order to constrict the light of enthusiasm within a person's heart so that it doesn't burn out and become null with Hashem's existence. If the person strengthens himself in serving Hashem, serving Him with the Attribute of constriction accordingly; then he'll merit comprehending Hashem's great light. Therefore, happy is the person who greatly strengthens himself with everything that he experiences; knowing very well that the sole purpose of the darkness and concealment is to bring him to the light and the revelation. For then he'll merit being elevated and bound with Hashem's Infinite Light and he'll experience it in this world. Happy is he and fortunate is his lot.

Mohorosh connected the above ideas to our *Parsha* in the most amazing way. The *Parsha* begins with (*Vayikra* 6:2) "Command Aaron and his sons, saying: This is the law of the burnt-offering: it is that which goes up on its firewood upon the altar all night unto the morning; and the fire of the altar shall be kept burning upon it." Perhaps we can say that the holy Torah is hinting us the way upon which to reach true success – that we need to serve Hashem within the Attribute of constriction; and through this we merit being elevated to lofty heights.

This is "Command Aaron and his sons, saying", because the command was specifically to Aaron and his sons, who are the tzaddikim who teach holy knowledge to the people, as it is written (*Malachi* 2:7), "For the lips of the *Kohen* will keep knowledge, and they will seek the law at his mouth." And the holy *Ohr HaChaim* states in the verse, "This is the law of the burnt-offering (*olah*)", that this service of elevating (*olah*) to Hashem a pleasing odor comes from the power of constriction and concealment from within the darkness of the night. For then is the preferred time to arouse the enthusiasm of the heart, to burn for Hashem with the Attribute of constriction.

This is, "it is that which goes up on its firewood upon the altar all night unto the morning" – the time for the burning of the burnt-offering was precisely at night, within the darkness and constriction. For when a person experiences darkness and concealment, it seems to him as though he has yet to do anything for Hashem; causing him to begin anew and his entire focus is to bind himself to Hashem. The night also hints to the time of revelation (as the *Ohr HaChaim* explains there); for then

the concealment is greatest and Hashem's unique pleasure from all of the service done for His sake. Also, the word "*Mokdah*" (firewood) is written with a small "*Mem*" – to hint to the constriction of the fire which should be controlled; because the attribute of constriction is needed in order to serve Hashem properly. Then one will merit, "and the fire of the altar shall be kept burning upon it" – that Hashem's Infinite light will burn in a controlled manner and the person will always merit serving Hashem in the right way.

This is what Rashi states, "The expression '*Tzav*' always denotes urging to promptly and meticulously fulfill a particular commandment for all generations. The verse is teaching us the way to serve Hashem for all generations, and how we should always strengthen ourselves in serving Hashem; by serving Him promptly and meticulously. On the other hand, serving Him within the constriction corresponds to (continuation of Rashi on this verse), "Rabbi Shimon taught: Scripture especially needs to urge people to fulfill commandments, where *monetary loss* is involved" – meaning, that the main meticulousness and promptness needs to be in a place where there's a monetary loss; that is, in a place where there's no constriction and concealment, and the person wants to go up without any boundaries and constrictions. For then there's fear that he not be consumed altogether due to the great enthusiasm. However, the fire that's "upon the *mokdah* (firewood) – written with a small "*mem*" – will also burn "all night unto the morning", and he's not afraid of the concealment and the darkness; rather, he only serves Hashem in everything that he's experiencing. Then, he'll merit "the fire of the altar shall be kept burning upon it", and the holy fire will always burn within him. And may Hashem grant us the merit to strengthen greatly ourselves in His service, and may we merit overcoming all of the darkness and obstacles in order to serve Him with a holy fire, until we merit being elevated and included in Him in truth, from now and forever. *Amen v'amen*.

